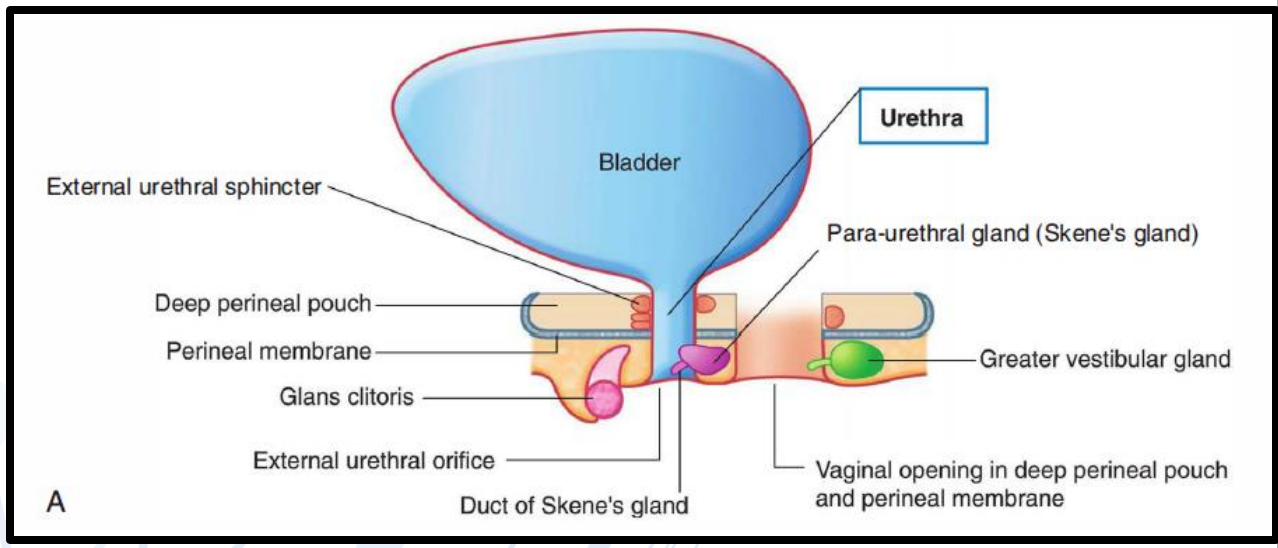
Female Urethra

- The female urethra is about 4 cm long. It extends from the neck of the bladder to the external meatus, where it opens into the vestibule of the vagina. It passes through perineal pouch and is surrounded by the sphincter urethrae. It lies in front of the vagina.

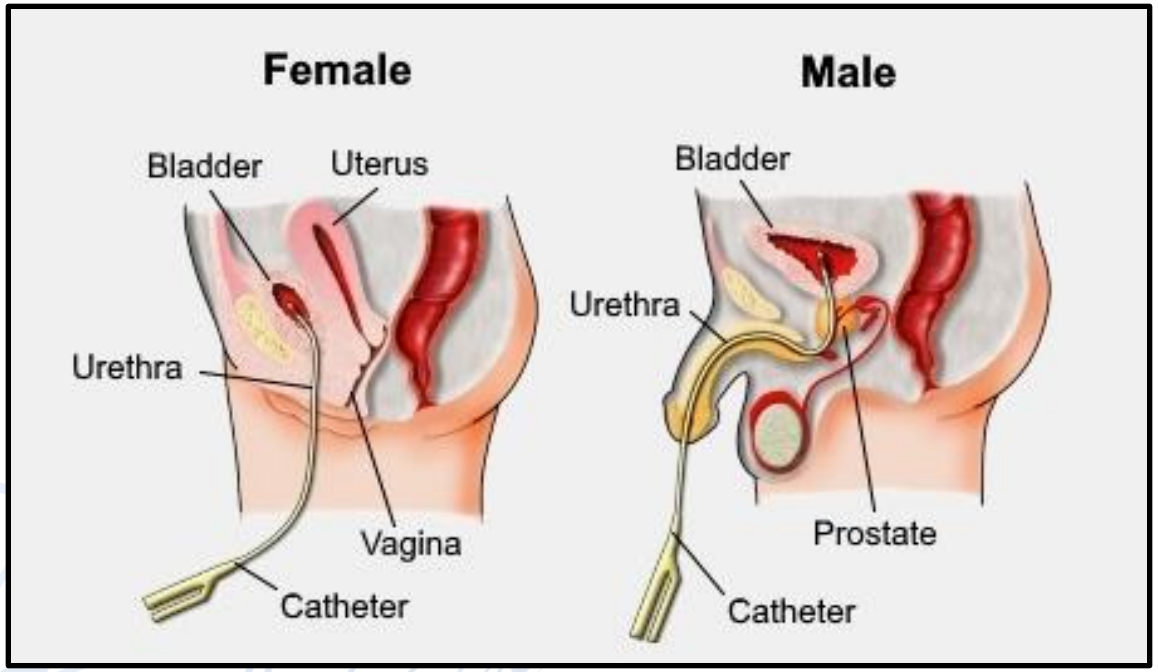


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Applied anatomy

Catheterization:

Because the female urethra is shorter, wider, and more dilatable, catheterization is much easier than in males. Moreover, the urethra is straight, and only minor resistance is felt as the catheter passes through the urethral sphincter.



Urethral Infection:

The short length of the female urethra predisposes to ascending infection; consequently, cystitis is more common in females than in males.

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